
FUNNEL HEALTH CHECKLIST

If pipeline is unpredictable, it is usually one of fifteen things.

This checklist walks through each one. It takes ten minutes to read and gives you a clear starting point before any conversation.

01

Strategy Foundations

02

Funnel Visibility

03

Demand Generation

04

Content & Conversion

05

Retention & Expansion

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About this checklist

Unpredictable pipeline is not a bad luck problem. It is a systems problem.

In fifteen-plus years in senior marketing leadership across B2B SaaS companies, I have seen the same gaps appear in teams at every stage. Including at Ignition, where ARR scaled from \$15 million to \$100 million+ over five years, representing nearly 10x growth. At SiteMinder, part of the growth from Series B through to \$100 million in ARR, a company that went on to list on the ASX at a \$1 billion valuation. At Genbook, part of the team through to acquisition by Booksy.

The companies with predictable pipeline are not necessarily spending more or working harder. They have simply closed the gaps that most teams leave open.

Most unpredictable pipeline problems come down to three or four items on this list. Not all fifteen. The skill is knowing which three or four apply to your business right now.

Work through each item honestly. Tick only what is genuinely in place and working today. Not what is planned. Not what is almost there. What exists and is actually producing results.

The gaps you find are your starting point.

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

Read each item carefully, including the description below the title. Tick the checkbox only if the item is genuinely in place. Note where you are uncertain. Uncertainty is a finding too. Three or more unchecked items in a single section indicates where to focus first.

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SECTION 1 | STRATEGY FOUNDATIONS

01 **You have a written ICP, not a vague persona** ☐

Most teams say they know their ICP. When I ask to see it, I get a slide with 'mid-market companies in fintech.' That is not an ICP. A real ICP names the firmographics, trigger events, the problem the buyer is trying to solve, what they have already tried, and why they end up choosing a solution like yours. Without it, every downstream decision is a guess.

From practice: At Ignition, the first thing we did before any campaign was get the ICP on one page. It changed what we said, who we targeted, and which channels we used.

02 **Your positioning is differentiated, not just a category claim** ☐

'We are the leading platform for X' is not positioning. It is a category claim. Real positioning answers one question: why would someone choose you over the obvious alternative? I have worked with companies that had genuinely better products but lost deals because they could not articulate the difference in one clear sentence. Get that sentence right and everything else becomes easier.

From practice: The best test: ask three people in your business to say your positioning out loud. If you get three different answers, you do not have positioning. You have a messaging problem.

03 **Sales and marketing share a definition of a qualified lead** ☐

This is the most common dysfunction I find in B2B SaaS teams. Marketing sends leads. Sales says they are junk. Nobody has agreed on what 'qualified' actually means. If your MQL definition is not written down, agreed on, and reviewed quarterly, you do not have an alignment problem. You have a definition problem. Fix that first.

From practice: I have seen this resolved in a single 90-minute session between the two teams. The definition is rarely the issue. The lack of one always is.

SECTION 2 | FUNNEL VISIBILITY

04 **You track conversion rates at every funnel stage** ☐

You cannot fix what you cannot see. I have walked into organisations with sophisticated ad tech stacks and zero visibility on how many visitors become leads, how many leads become meetings, how many meetings become opportunities. If you cannot answer those four numbers off the top of your head, your funnel is a black box.

From practice: Once you have these numbers, even rough ones, the constraint becomes obvious. Usually it is not where people assume it is.

05 You know your average sales cycle and where deals stall ☐

Average sales cycle length is a basic metric. More useful is knowing where in the cycle deals go quiet. After the first meeting? After the demo? After the proposal? The place where deals stall is almost always where a specific concern has not been addressed. Knowing it means you can fix it.

From practice: In one team I worked with, 60% of deals stalled post-demo. It was not the product. It was the absence of a clear next step and the right follow-up content.

06 You have working attribution across your main channels ☐

'Attribution is imperfect' is true. 'Attribution is impossible, so we do not bother' is a cop-out. You do not need perfect multi-touch attribution. You need to know, broadly, which channels are producing qualified pipeline. First-touch and last-touch, even imperfectly applied, is infinitely more useful than nothing.

From practice: If your team cannot make a budget decision based on channel data, the attribution is not working, regardless of what tools you have installed.

07 You run a consistent pipeline review cadence ☐

Unpredictable pipeline is often a symptom of irregular review. If you only look at pipeline when a quarter is going wrong, you are already too late. A weekly or fortnightly review, even a short one, surfaces problems early enough to act on them. I have seen teams double pipeline predictability by making this single change.

From practice: The meeting needs to be in the calendar and it needs to happen. 'We look at it informally' is not a cadence. It is an avoidance strategy.

SECTION 3 | DEMAND GENERATION**08 You have at least one compounding channel** ☐

Paid advertising works. It stops the moment you stop paying. A compounding channel (SEO, a referral programme, a community, a newsletter) keeps producing results over time. Every sustainable B2B SaaS marketing engine I have seen has at least one working. If your pipeline depends entirely on ads, you are one budget cut away from a crisis.

From practice: Compounding channels take time. The companies that have them started building earlier than felt necessary. That is the whole point.

09 No single channel represents more than 50% of your pipeline ☐

Single-channel dependency is a pipeline risk that gets overlooked until it fails. Algorithm changes, rising CPCs, platform policy shifts. Any of these can take out a single-channel model overnight. The answer is not to be everywhere. It is to have two or three channels working well enough that losing one does not create a crisis.

From practice: I have seen this happen. A Google algorithm update wiped out 40% of pipeline overnight for a company over-indexed on organic. Build the redundancy before you need it.

10 **You are nurturing leads who are not ready to buy now** ☐

At any given moment, roughly 97% of your addressable market is not ready to buy. Most marketing programmes optimise for the 3%. The companies that grow predictably build relationships with the 97%, through content, email, retargeting, and community, so they are already warm when timing aligns. If you have no nurture motion, you are generating pipeline for your competitors.

From practice: A simple email nurture programme, even six to eight emails over three months, changes the quality of inbound dramatically when those contacts eventually raise their hand.

SECTION 4 | CONTENT AND CONVERSION

11 **You have content for every stage of the buying journey** ☐

Most B2B SaaS content programmes are heavy on awareness (blogs, social posts) and thin on decision-stage content (case studies, comparison pages, ROI frameworks). A buyer who is close to a decision needs different information than one who has just discovered the problem. If you only produce one type of content, you only serve one stage.

From practice: Decision-stage content is consistently underinvested. It is also consistently the highest-ROI content to produce. Start there if you are building from scratch.

12 **You have strong proof points, not just testimonials** ☐

A quote that says 'this product changed our business' is close to worthless. What changed? By how much? In what timeframe? A proof point that answers those three questions clearly is consistently the most effective sales content in the kit. If your proof points are vague, rewrite them. If you do not have any, that is your next marketing priority.

From practice: At SiteMinder, specific outcome data in sales materials shortened sales cycles measurably. Buyers want evidence, not enthusiasm.

13 **Your trial or demo process removes friction, not adds it** ☐

The moment a prospect decides to take action, do not make them wait. Long demo booking flows, multi-step qualification forms, a 48-hour response time. These kill momentum at the highest-intent moment in your funnel. If you would not accept that experience as a buyer, fix it.

From practice: Audit the path from 'I want to see the product' to 'I am in the product.' Every extra click is a leak.

SECTION 5 | RETENTION AND EXPANSION

14 You measure net revenue retention, not just new ARR

New ARR growth built on a leaky base is a treadmill. If you are churning 15% of revenue annually and celebrating top-of-funnel growth, you are working harder for less. Net revenue retention (what percentage of last year's revenue is still with you, plus expansion) is the metric that most honestly reflects business health. If your marketing team does not have this number, they are missing half the picture.

From practice: Marketing can influence retention and expansion directly. The teams that do grow faster and more predictably than the ones that stop at the close.

15 Marketing is involved in onboarding and retention, not just acquisition

The best acquisition channel is a customer who stays and expands. In every high-performing B2B SaaS business I have worked in, marketing played a role in onboarding, adoption, and expansion, not just lead generation. If marketing hands off at the point of close and never looks back, you are leaving significant revenue on the table.

From practice: This does not require a full customer marketing programme from day one. It starts with marketing owning one retention or expansion initiative and building from there.

Three or more gaps in any section tells you where to start.

The companies that improve pipeline predictability fastest do not try to fix everything at once. They identify the highest-impact constraint and address it properly before moving to the next one.

If this checklist has surfaced something useful, I offer a free 30-minute diagnostic call. No pitch. Just a direct conversation about where the constraint is and what is worth prioritising first.

I work with a small number of B2B SaaS founders and marketing leaders at a time. If you are at Series A or B, building a marketing function that needs to match your sales team's ambition, that is the conversation I am built for.

BOOK A FREE 30-MINUTE DIAGNOSTIC

calendly.com/bronwynkaraoglu/30min

No pitch. Just a direct conversation about what to prioritise first.

15+

years in senior marketing leadership in B2B SaaS

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ARR at Ignition. Nearly 10x growth over five years

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the stage where marketing decisions matter most

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